



Hurricane Frequently Asked Questions

Last Revised: April 2025

In order to better assist residents with preparing for a severe weather event, the following questions and answers are periodically updated.

Before the Storm

Q: What can I do to prepare for a hurricane or tropical storm event?

A: The best way to prepare for a hurricane is to make sure you are informed and have an evacuation plan in place. Please be sure to reference a copy of the Community Association's Hurricane Preparedness Guide for tips on creating a disaster supply kit and personal evacuation plan, as well as learning how to stay informed and how to protect your home.

Q: Where can I find the Hurricane Preparedness Guide?

A: The Hurricane Preparedness Guide is available for download from the community website.

Q: What does the Community Association do when a storm is headed our way?

A: Every year in early spring, the Community Association reviews its hurricane preparedness plans. If and when a storm is in the Atlantic with a projected landfall in the Southeast, preparation meetings are held with the directors and managers to review the playbooks for each department. The General Manager, Board of Directors and Securitas also meet to discuss plans for closing the amenities and issuing evacuation procedures. Communication between the Board, Securitas and the Association is fluid and continuous.

Q: When can I put up my storm shutters?

A: Per the Community Rules, hurricane shutters may be installed or closed when a storm is probable. Typically, this means when the Sun City area is included in the cone of uncertainty on the national hurricane weather maps.

Q: Will the Community Association assist with preparing resident property for an evacuation?

A: The Community Association is responsible for protecting the common area assets. It is the responsibility of each individual owner or renter to prepare their own personal property during a severe weather event. Download a copy of the Community Association's Hurricane Preparedness Guide for information on what types of measures to take to secure your personal property and evacuate safely.

Community Closure Information

Q: Who decides whether the community will remain open or closed?

A: When there is a mandatory evacuation ordered by the Governor of South Carolina, the community will always close.

Each storm is handled on a case-by-case basis and the Board of Directors may close amenities before a governor-mandated evacuation based on a number of factors, including the projected storm path and



road conditions. During any severe weather event, the Board receives regular updates from Securitas and local emergency services on possible area impacts.

In other cases, the Community Association (under the direction of the Board) will follow the Beaufort County directive as it relates to preparing and closing amenities inside Sun City.

Neighborhoods inside Sun City spread across Beaufort and Jasper counties. During severe weather events, Jasper County follows the lead from Beaufort County for evacuations. Evacuation zones south of I-95 include Sun City neighborhoods in Jasper County, which will be included in the evacuation order. For more information on evacuation zones, visit www.scemd.org/prepare/know-your-zone.

Q: Will the community close for other inclement weather events?

A: The Board of Directors may decide to close Sun City in the event of other severe weather events such as snow, ice, rain or wind. In such cases, the Community Association (under the direction of the Board) follows Beaufort County directives as it relates to closing.

Q: What does the Community Association do when the decision is made to close the community for a hurricane?

A: A limited number of staff will prepare the community for the storm and take the necessary measures to protect Association property. The process of securing Sun City takes time. Preparations include putting up barricades, shuttering windows at common area facilities, securing Association property (umbrellas, pool furniture, golf course flags, etc.) The Association will share updates regarding preparations and property closures as information becomes available.

Q: What should I do as a resident when the decision is made to close the community for an approaching hurricane?

A: Residents are strongly encouraged to evacuate in advance of a governor-issued evacuation order. Individuals are responsible to prepare their personal property in the event of a hurricane. See the Hurricane Preparedness Guide for suggestions and information.

Q: How does the Community Association handle my personal data and information during a hurricane?

A: The community's technology is primarily cloud-based, meaning your personal data will be safe at all times.

Q: What criteria are used for closing the gates during a hurricane evacuation?

A: If and when the governor issues an evacuation order, the Community Association will prepare Sun City for a closure. It takes anywhere from four to six hours to put the barricades in place and fill them with water to guide residents out of the community. The Association will make every effort to prepare the community well before an actual evacuation order is issued by the governor. This means barricades will be ready and waiting beside the gates before they are actually moved into position.

Once barricades are moved into place, residents will be required to follow the internal routes to exit Sun City. There are only four gates approved for exiting the community once the barricades are in place:

- Lake Somerset Gate
- North Gate on Hwy. 278



- Riverbend Gate
- Sun City West Gate

Only the four gates listed above are approved by the Department of Transportation for exiting Sun City in the event of an evacuation order. Exiting through these gates allows the South Carolina Highway Patrol to filter traffic into the appropriate state-approved evacuation routes to prevent gridlock.

All the other outbound gates including the Bull Hill Gate and Tidewatch Gate are locked in the down position once an evacuation order is issued. This is to prevent residents from exiting into a pre-designated state evacuation route.

All inbound gates will ALWAYS operate normally. Residents are ALWAYS allowed back into the community assuming they are able to reach the inbound gates. It is possible for a resident to leave the community (for example, going to the store) and have difficulty re-entering since law enforcement is pushing drivers to follow the evacuation routes.

Once a resident leaves the property, they must follow the rules and regulations of the local authorities directing traffic.

Q: Who should residents rely on for information regarding the timing of barricade placement in the community?

A: For information specifically about Sun City, residents should rely on Community Association news updates **only**. Barricades are placed into the roads if and when an evacuation order has been issued by the governor.

Q: Do the gates continue to operate if amenities close without an evacuation order?

A: If an evacuation order is **not** in effect, residents may come and go through any and all gates as they wish.

Q: Why is the Millennium Bridge closed so far in advance of an approaching storm?

A: The Millennium Bridge is not safe for residents to travel across during a storm with high winds. In addition, barricades are placed at the base of the bridge to restrict residents who live south of Hwy. 278 from attempting to go to the north side in order to exit onto Hwy. 278.

The Department of Transportation has established exit/evacuation routes based on whether residents live on north or south side of the community.

It takes anywhere from four to six hours to put the barricades into position prior to an evacuation. Barricades will sit at the sides of the road until an evacuation order is issued at which time they will be moved into place to control the flow of traffic exiting onto the main surrounding arteries.

Q: How do I know which route to follow in the event of an evacuation order?

A: If the area is under a governor-issued evacuation order, there is a specific evacuation route set forth by the state and enforced by the South Carolina Highway Patrol, and the Beaufort and Jasper county sheriff's offices. The evacuation routes funnel residents north out of Sun City.



Only four gates will allow residents to exit the community:

- Lake Somerset
- North Gate on Hwy. 278
- Riverbend Gate
- Sun City West Gate

All other outbound gates will be closed to prevent residents from exiting incorrectly into the pre-established evacuation routes. The evacuation routes are established by the state to control the traffic flow out of the area.

Please find the Sun City evacuation map in the Hurricane Preparedness Guide and keep it handy in the event of an evacuation.

Q: After I leave the community, how do I know what roads to take and which locations are far enough away from the storm?

A: Build your personal evacuation plan before you leave the community. Take the time to do your research before the storm approaches. Identify inland hotels that will take reservations in advance, and check their cancellation and pet policies. Hurricanes are a moving target, so keep an eye on the news to track the storm's path and determine what areas are least likely to be impacted by the storm. Visit the South Carolina Department of Transportation's website (www.scdot.org) to find evacuation routes for the entire state. Most importantly, leave early so you can travel freely throughout the state.



Amenities

Q: When are hurricane shutters installed on community buildings?

A: The Community Association and Board review projections for wind in our area to determine if it warrants installing the shutters. If so, shutters will be staged at buildings, and **IF** time permits, staff will install the shutters. It takes the Operations staff a day and a half to install shutters on all of the buildings.

Q. Why do we close down amenities so far in advance of an approaching storm?

A: The size and complexity of our property and amenities is more intricate than some of the surrounding small cities and towns.

1. It takes a tremendous amount of time, effort and resources to secure \$145 million worth of assets. The timing of an evacuation order dictates how long the Association has to prepare the property.
2. Advanced planning is required in order to allow adequate time for staff to return to their homes to prepare their personal property for the approaching storm. Many employees live on barrier islands or south of the community in Georgia. Once the highways are closed to south or westbound traffic, employees living in these areas will be unable travel back to their own homes and families if they are still working on property.

Q: Why can't the amenities stay open without staff?

A: Amenities are closed to protect the assets and for the safety of the residents.

Q: Do the golf courses close when the community closes for a hurricane or weather event?

A: Yes, all three golf courses and pro shops take proper measures to close and protect the courses when the community closes. It is important for residents to stay off the golf courses during closures and inclement weather to avoid damage to the courses.

Q: Do the restaurants close when the community closes for a hurricane or weather event?

A: Jameson's Charhouse, the Clubhouse at Okatie Creek and AL's Pub at Argent Lakes are privately owned. Therefore, the restaurant owners make their own decisions regarding closing and opening. However, if the community is closing, the buildings that house the restaurants will be closed, as well.

Q. Why not keep open the non-staffed amenities such as the Card Room, Billiards Room, Yemassee Craft Center, Woodworkers Shop, etc.?

A. These facilities receive daily maintenance and cleaning services, which cannot be provided during a closure without staff. Security resources are allocated to handle storm-related activities, and if we require Security to open buildings, it detracts them from the tasks they must perform to protect community assets. Safety concerns are also a real risk.

Q. When and how do you decide to reopen the closed amenities?

A. In the event of an evacuation, reopening depends on when the county will allow staff to return and the staff's assessment of the damage to the property. The Board and Association also consider the



availability of staff when making a decision to reopen. Staff may not be able to return to their homes or Sun City immediately following the storm, depending on the damage sustained in their local areas.

Communication

Q: How do I get information from the Community Association during a hurricane or weather-related closure?

A: There are several options:

- Opt-in to eNews Weekly to receive email updates.
- Check the community website at www.SunCityHiltonHead.org.

Q: What kind of information can I find on the community website?

The community website includes:

- Sign-up instructions for Everbridge/Nixle
- Updates from the Association
- The Hurricane Preparedness Guide
- Hurricane Education Video Series
- Hurricane FAQs
- Sun City's evacuation map

Q: What will the Community Association communicate during and after an evacuation?

A: The Community Association will provide information about when amenities and the community will close and reopen, when staff will depart, recovery updates and information about the clean-up process and procedures. Please note that Sun City may not open even if the governor-issued evacuation has been lifted. Always refer to Sun City-specific communication before attempting to return to the community.

Q: Will the Community Association provide updates on my home and personal property during an evacuation?

A: The Community Association and Securitas cannot provide you with information on your personal property during an evacuation or closure. Staff, if available during an evacuation, are attending to the common area assets and addressing the emergency needs for the community property.

Residents Who Choose to Not Evacuate

It is highly recommended residents evacuate when the governor issues a mandatory evacuation order.

Q. Can residents who do not evacuate during a governor-issued evacuation leave and re-enter via designated evacuation gates?

A. It is highly recommended that you evacuate during a governor-issued evacuation.



In the event you choose not to evacuate, and you come and go from Sun City gates, you must exit using one of the four designated gates:

- Lake Somerset
- North Gate on Hwy. 278
- Riverbend
- Sun City West

All other outbound gates including the Bull Hill Gate and Tidewatch Gate are locked in the down position to prevent residents from exiting into evacuation traffic incorrectly. All inbound gates will remain operable at all times.

Residents exiting the community can re-enter at any time, assuming local law enforcement does not prohibit access. Local law enforcement may restrict vehicle movement outside Sun City as their main objective is to filter the population away from the area. They have the authority to control traffic flow, which could affect your ability to return to the community.

Residents who choose to stay in Sun City must be aware of the county and state evacuation routes and procedures.

After the evacuation is lifted, residents must also be aware that law enforcement may place barriers at various "entry points" into the county to regulate re-entry.

Q. For those residents who choose to stay, will amenities be open so they can continue their normal activities?

A. No. To protect the community assets (amenities) and for the safety of all residents, if amenities are closed during a storm event, they will not be available for use by those who choose to remain behind. Please keep in mind that per Board Policy No. 1803.6, anyone who enters a restricted area or uses an amenity when it has been designated as "closed" by the Community Association can be fined a trespassing fee and/or loss of Community Association privileges for each violation. Fees can be found in the Schedule of Fees and Community Rules.

Q. What if I decide not to evacuate and experience a medical emergency at home?

A. During an evacuation, emergency services may not be available to assist you. If you remain at home during a governor-issued evacuation, you accept the responsibility of caring for yourself. Power outages and road conditions may limit medical personnel from reaching you during the storm and after the evacuation order is lifted.

Post-Hurricane

Q: How do I know when I can return to Sun City?

A: State or county officials make the decision on reopening Beaufort or Jasper counties after a storm. After the decision is made, the Community Association will assess any damage and decide when to reopen the community and amenities. Watch for communication from the association to find out if the community has been cleared for re-entry.



Q. Per the SCHH Hurricane Preparedness Guide, "Hurricane shutters should be removed within 10 days after the threat of a storm has passed." What does this mean?

A: The Association will publish a target date by which shutters should be removed. If access to the community is restricted immediately after the storm, this period of time will be lengthened. Either way, the Board of Directors will provide a date by which shutters should be down.

Q. If I evacuate and can't get back within 10 days to take my shutters down, will I be fined?

A: The Association uses common sense judgement to allow residents ample time to remove their shutters. You can be fined, however, if they remain up too long.

Q: Will the Community Association clear trees that fall on my property from common area property?

A: The Community Association is not responsible for common area trees that fall on private lots. The removal of trees is the individual homeowner's responsibility.

Q: Do I need approval from the Modifications department to repair damage done to my home during a storm?

A: The following repairs require residents to sign and submit a Declaration Form for review:

- Removing damaged trees from the homeowner's property
- Replacing more than 50 percent of the roof or replacing a portion of the roof with a different but pre-approved color or texture roof
- Replacing broken windows with a similar style
- Replacing more than 50 percent of all exterior wall materials
- Repainting exterior walls or doors and garage doors with a different but pre-approved color

The required form can be found on the community website as "SCHH Emergency Guidelines for Residential Permits and Inspections." If you have additional questions, please email modifications@schhca.com.